

Pet emergency financial planning — Action Checklist

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COMPLETE YOUR PET RISK PROFILE

- ☐ **Complete Your Pet Risk Profile:** Write down your pet's species, breed, and age in a notebook or phone note so you have baseline information ready when researching costs and risks.
- ☐ **Research Breed-Specific Conditions:** Search breed health databases like the AKC Canine Health Foundation to find the three highest-cost emergency conditions your specific breed faces.
- ☐ **Consult Your Veterinarian:** Call your vet and ask which two to three conditions your breed is most likely to experience—most vets answer this in under a minute and it gives you personalized risk insight.
- ☐ **Identify Your Most Likely Risk:** Determine which of your breed's high-cost conditions is most likely given your pet's current age and health status, then circle that condition in your notes.

CALCULATE YOUR EMERGENCY FUND GAP

- ☐ **Tally Your Current Emergency Savings:** Write down the exact dollar amount you currently have saved for emergencies so you have a clear baseline before calculating your actual coverage gap.
- ☐ **Compare Savings to Real Emergency Costs:** Compare your current savings against the \$3,000–\$10,000 cost range for real emergencies like foreign body surgery, trauma, and critical illness hospitalization.
- ☐ **Calculate Your Emergency Fund Gap:** Subtract what you currently have saved from what your highest-risk scenario would cost to get a specific dollar figure that represents your coverage gap.
- ☐ **Set a Realistic Savings Target:** Establish a concrete savings goal based on your most expensive likely scenario so you have a specific number to work toward instead of a vague one.

BUILD YOUR FINANCIAL SAFETY NET

- ☐ **Research Pet Insurance Providers:** Compare at least three pet insurance companies by reviewing their annual premiums, coverage limits, deductibles, and any breed-specific exclusions before purchasing.
 - ☐ **Apply for Veterinary Financing Early:** Apply for a CareCredit account or similar veterinary financing card while you don't have an urgent bill—this gives you instant options when crises hit.
 - ☐ **Ask About Payment Plans Upfront:** Call your vet's office and ask whether they offer payment plans, sliding scale fees, or are willing to negotiate costs before an emergency forces a rushed decision.
 - ☐ **Create a Written Emergency Contact Plan:** Write down your insurance policy details, financing options, vet contact information, and a support person's number so you have a clear action list during a crisis.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.